

Incretin-based Drugs Market Overview 2026 and Forecast till 2035

The global incretin-based drugs market was valued at USD 38.69 billion in 2025 and is projected to exceed USD 72.63 billion by 2035. The market is expected to expand at a CAGR of more than 6.5% during the forecast period from 2026 to 2035. Rising prevalence of diabetes and obesity, increasing adoption of advanced glucose-lowering therapies, and continuous innovation in metabolic disease treatment are expected to drive long-term market growth.

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Incretin-based Drugs Industry Demand

[Incretin-based drugs](#) are a class of medications used primarily for the management of type 2 diabetes and, increasingly, obesity-related conditions. These therapies work by enhancing the activity of incretin hormones that regulate insulin secretion, suppress glucagon production, and improve blood glucose control. The two major categories of incretin-based therapies are glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonists and dipeptidyl peptidase-4 (DPP-4) inhibitors.

Demand for these drugs continues to rise due to their proven effectiveness in controlling blood sugar levels while offering additional benefits such as weight management and cardiovascular risk reduction. Growing awareness of diabetes management, improved healthcare access, and the increasing burden of metabolic disorders are further supporting market expansion. Pharmaceutical companies are also introducing innovative formulations with improved convenience, extended dosing intervals, and enhanced patient adherence. Additionally, favorable reimbursement policies in several countries and growing physician preference for targeted therapies are contributing to sustained market demand.

Incretin-based Drugs Market: Growth Drivers & Key Restraint

Growth Drivers

- **Rising Prevalence of Diabetes and Obesity:** The rising global prevalence of type 2 diabetes and obesity continues to be the key driver behind the growing demand for incretin-based treatments. Changing lifestyles, unhealthy dietary habits, and sedentary behavior have significantly increased the need for effective long-term treatment options.
- **Advancements in Drug Development:** Continuous innovation in pharmaceutical research has led to the development of more effective and patient-friendly incretin-based medications. Improved formulations, combination therapies, and next-generation delivery technologies are enhancing treatment outcomes and encouraging broader adoption.

- **Growing Focus on Comprehensive Metabolic Health:** Healthcare providers are increasingly seeking therapies that offer benefits beyond glucose control. Incretin-based drugs have gained attention due to their potential impact on weight reduction, cardiovascular health, and overall metabolic management, strengthening their position in treatment guidelines.

Restraint

- **High Treatment Costs and Accessibility Challenges:** Despite their clinical benefits, incretin-based therapies often carry higher costs compared to traditional diabetes medications. In some regions, limited affordability and insufficient reimbursement support can reduce patient access and create challenges for broader market adoption.

Incretin-based Drugs Market: Segment Analysis

Segment Analysis by Administration Method

Oral Drugs

The oral drugs segment is witnessing growing interest due to its convenience and improved patient compliance. Patients generally prefer oral medications because they eliminate the need for injections and simplify long-term disease management. Ongoing innovation in oral formulations is expected to strengthen this segment's market position.

Injectable Drugs

Injectable incretin-based therapies continue to hold a significant share of the market owing to their established clinical efficacy and widespread physician acceptance. Advanced injectable formulations offering reduced dosing frequency and improved therapeutic outcomes continue to support segment growth.

Segment Analysis by Drug Type

Glucagon-like Peptide-1 Receptor (GLP-1) Agonists

GLP-1 receptor agonists represent a major segment of the market due to their strong effectiveness in glycemic control and weight management. Growing clinical evidence supporting cardiovascular and metabolic benefits has significantly increased their adoption among healthcare providers. Continued product innovation and expanding therapeutic applications are expected to drive sustained demand.

Dipeptidyl Peptidase-4 (DPP-4) Inhibitors

DPP-4 inhibitors remain an important treatment option for patients requiring convenient and well-tolerated diabetes management therapies. Their favorable safety profile, oral administration route, and compatibility with combination treatment regimens contribute to their continued use across various patient populations.

Incretin-based Drugs Market: Regional Insights

North America

North America represents a leading market for incretin-based drugs due to high diabetes prevalence, advanced healthcare infrastructure, and strong adoption of innovative pharmaceutical therapies. Extensive research activities, favorable reimbursement frameworks, and growing awareness of obesity management continue to support regional demand.

Europe

Europe maintains a substantial market presence driven by increasing rates of metabolic disorders, supportive healthcare systems, and widespread access to advanced treatment options. Government initiatives focused on chronic disease management and preventive healthcare are further contributing to market expansion across the region.

Asia-Pacific (APAC)

Asia-Pacific is expected to witness the fastest growth due to the rapidly increasing diabetic population, urbanization, and changing lifestyle patterns. Rising healthcare expenditure, improved access to modern therapies, and expanding pharmaceutical investments are creating significant opportunities for market growth throughout the region.

Top Players in the Incretin-based Drugs Market

Major companies operating in the global incretin-based drugs market include GlaxoSmithKline Plc., Boehringer Ingelheim GmbH., Merck & Co., Inc., Takeda Pharmaceutical Company Ltd., Sanofi S.A., AstraZeneca Plc., Eli Lilly and Company, Johnson & Johnson, Novartis AG, Novo Nordisk, and Rani Therapeutics Holdings, Inc. These companies are actively engaged in research and development, product innovation, strategic collaborations, and portfolio expansion to strengthen their market position and address the growing demand for advanced diabetes and metabolic disorder treatments.

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